

Lord, I want to be a Christian

Text: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907
LORD, I WANT TO BE irregular

Music: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907

The musical score is written for a single voice in 4/4 time, using a treble clef and a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The melody is simple and repetitive, with a final cadence at the end of the fourth line. The lyrics are aligned with the notes, with some words split across lines. The first line includes four numbered variations of the lyrics. The second line is a full line of the melody. The third line consists of two phrases, each with a long note. The fourth line is another full line of the melody, ending with a double bar line.

1 Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart, in my heart.
2 Lord, I want to be more lov - ing...
3 Lord, I want to be more ho - ly...
4 Lord, I want to be like Je - sus...

Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.

In my heart, in my heart,

Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.